

## STARTER

# Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Germany - National Student Visa (Type D)

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German National Student Visa refusals are decided by the consulate under the Residence Act, generally without an interview, though some missions do interview applicants for this route more often than for the Schengen Tourist Visa.

## The most common specific reasons

### 1. Zulassungsbescheid details don't match the application

- Double-check your university, programme, and start date against your admission letter before submitting
- If you're switching from conditional to full admission (e.g. after a Studienkolleg year), make sure your application reflects your current status accurately

### 2. Sperrkonto or financial evidence issues

- The required amount is published and specific, not a judgement call - see the Financial Requirements Overview
- Using an unapproved provider, or a mechanism other than a Sperrkonto without confirming it's accepted, is a common avoidable problem

### 3. Missing APS certificate

If your country requires an APS certificate (commonly China, Vietnam, and in some cases India), applying without one is a straightforward, avoidable refusal ground - confirm whether this applies to your nationality well before applying, since it takes real time to obtain.

### 4. Health insurance not properly arranged

Confirm whether GKV (statutory) or private insurance applies to you, and arrange it correctly - the wrong type of cover for your circumstances can hold up your application.

### 5. Incomplete or inconsistent immigration history

Disclose all previous visas, visits, and refusals honestly - undisclosed history is treated far more seriously than the history itself would usually be.

**REMONSTRATION APPLIES HERE TOO**

As with the Tourist Visa, a refused National Student Visa application can be challenged first through a Remonstrationsverfahren filed with the same consulate, and - if that doesn't succeed - through judicial review at the Verwaltungsgericht Berlin. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier).